

PetPal - Reflection

CST8318 - Final Project

Report by: Andrew Tan & Richard Duong

Our final project was the creation of **PetPal**, a pet care management app designed in Figma. The purpose of the app was to help users manage important pet information in one place, such as schedules, appointments, health records, reminders, and pet profiles. Throughout the semester, we combined our earlier wireframes, design systems, and prototype work into one final design.

The final prototype included several main pages such as a landing page, login and sign up pages, dashboard, My Pets page, Schedule page, and Health Records page. We also created pop-up forms such as Add Pet and Add Task. Our goal was to make the design clean, simple, and easy to navigate using a teal colour theme.

One of the biggest lessons we learned was the importance of planning properly. The project was fun, but at times it became stressful because we moved too quickly into designing without organizing everything first. Looking back, the process would have been smoother if we followed each step in order and planned more carefully.

Another lesson was about using components in Figma. We created too many duplicate components instead of reusing the same ones with variants. For example, buttons and text fields could have been made more efficiently. This taught us that keeping components organized saves time and makes changes easier later.

We also realized that our colour palette could have been stronger. While the teal theme looked clean and consistent, some pages used too much of the same colour. Adding more accent colours would improve contrast and make the design more visually balanced.

From a usability point of view, we learned that designers should not assume users automatically know how to use a website. Some areas of our prototype would benefit from clearer labels, tooltips, or instructions for first-time users.

We also noticed that some dashboard features looked good visually but were not fully realistic yet. For example, charts and percentages would need real data in an actual working app. This reminded us that prototypes should look good while also making sense functionally.

Time management was another important lesson. Near the end of the project, we ran out of time and had to prioritize certain pages. Looking back, features like the Notifications page may have been more useful to complete than some less important sections.

Overall, this project gave us strong experience in the full design process, including planning, wireframing, design systems, prototyping, and teamwork. While there are things we would improve, the final result successfully shows a functional and organized pet care app. It also taught us valuable lessons about planning, teamwork, and designing for users.